the people. The declaration also called on SLORC to enter into negotiations with the NLD to bring about reconciliation. Furthermore, the immediate release of key NLD leaders and other political prisoners was essential. The NLD also claimed that the model for a new constitution would be the 1947 document rather than the previous constitution of 1974.

The sangha attempted to take action to help facilitate change. Monks joined with NLD supporters to commemorate the events of August 1988 often referred to as 8888. To pressure the military, monks were told not to accept offerings from the tatmadaw. This turning over of the offering bowl is the equivalent of excommunication. Offerings are the main way Buddhists earn merit. Since most members of the military were Buddhist, this tactic could have potentially damaged the legitimacy of the regime. The leadership retaliated by arresting monks, raiding monasteries, and pressuring the Buddhist leadership to resend earlier orders. By late October, the government took indirect control over the monks.

International pressure on SLORC increased during the summer of 1990. Rather than reconciliation, the junta responded with internal repression. Hundreds were arrested and pressure mounted on the remaining NLD members to force Suu Kyi and Tin U out of the party. The entire election process helped to flush out additional opponents of the regime. This in turn helped the junta to further consolidate power.